

Family Focus



Railroads play major role in county growth



In its prime, the railroad station of the Nickel Plate was the busiest place in town. This photo shows a passenger train at the depot, passengers and the Brady Elevator, the grist mill and Stimmel elevator in the background. (1910 photo)



Keith McCullough is the sole remaining railroad station agent in Paulding County. He sits at his desk in the old depot beside the tracks in Payne.

of-way. So confident were all that the road would this time be built that villages were located at every available point along the line. But it was not to be again. For nearly ten years it waited, finally being resurrected in 1881 by a young railroad man named Calvin T. Brice. Brice later became a United States senator.

Work on the line was completed through the county in September, 1881. An old settler who had been fooled too many times before, watched construction going on and is said to have remarked,

"This 'ere road will never be built."

The line through the county is a straight one,

having a one minute deflection from a direct east and west course. In 1892 its assessed value was \$200,000.

In 1887 a line was completed from Van Wert north across the county, called the Cincinnati, Van Wert and Michigan. In 1892 it was a big convenience for county people who could leave Paulding on the early morning train, arrive at Cincinnati about 10 a.m., have time to spend in the city and reach home again the same day.

In the summer of 1883, the American Midland, or Mahoning railroad, was graded through the southern part of the county, parallel to the Nickel Plate, and about

four miles south of it. The road then, like some of its predecessors, passed into a quiet sleep from which it was fully awakened in the fall of 1891. Two trunk lines passed through Paulding county east and west; and the Mackinaw cut through the center north and south. Upon the prospects of the Mahoning road the villages of Grover Hill and Mandale were located upon its line in the county.

In this year of 1978 the only full time active line is that of the Norfolk and Western which is also in control of the old Wabash track. The east-west line passing through the center of the county was rebuilt recently, and is a con-

tinuous rail. It was put in quarter sections and welded at the seams, making the passage of the miles-long freight trains comparatively silent.

Station agent at Payne, the only remaining station in Paulding county, is Keith McCullough, a native of Oakwood. McCullough has been the agent at Payne since May 1961, having been employed by the Chicago Rock Island, and Pacific Line before 1961.

Keith's father and uncle worked for the old Nickel Plate road, making theirs a railroad family.

"When the railroads came, the canals declined and disappeared, when the trucks and planes came,

the railroads declined," said McCullough. "And the passenger car destroyed the passenger trains."

"I don't know what the future holds. There is so much talk with this Congress. We hear we need railroads for the national economy; they claim it's the cheapest way to move material," said Keith.

"Nothing has been settled in the strike action of last spring and summer. We went back to work as ordered by a federal judge. What is happening now, I don't know. All I really know about is what goes on the railroad in Payne. It's a busy one and we do a lot of business!"

between those two points, a distance of seven miles. According to the Atlas, its struggles were manifold and its ups and downs numerous.

It was a rickety affair and it is thought the proprietor never realized much profit upon the amount he invested. In 1879 it was reconstructed and became a standard gauge road with the first train running over it in 1880. For a time it was owned by S. Frank Eagle and the Paulding and Cecil railway. It was sold in 1884 to the Cincinnati, Van Wert and Michigan Company. In 1892 it was a part of the Cincinnati, Jackson and Mackinaw Road.

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END



In 1872 the name was changed to "Continental Railway" and work began again along the right-



Norm's news

'REMEMBER WHEN?'
By NORM RULMAN

(History of Paulding County, taken from the Historical Atlas of Paulding County Canals and Railroads.)

"The first railroad built through the county was the Toledo, Wabash and Western, now called the Wabash, St. Louis and Pacific.

"Gen. W. H. Gibson and Gen. James H. Steadman had charge of its construction between Defiance and Ft. Wayne. It passes through the northern part for a distance of 18 miles and was completed in 1855.

"The construction of the road, at this comparatively early date, is mainly due to the untiring energy of some of the enterprising citizens of Defiance, as is told by the late lamented Hon. W.C. Holgate, of that city, in a historical address before a meeting of the Maumee Valley Pioneer Association, and was published in the Defiance Democrat, February 28, 1878.

"He says, 'Prior to 1842, the chief mode of travel was on foot or on horseback, and the chief means of transportation of goods and produce was by pirogues or flat boats on the rivers. Our merchants and those of Ft. Wayne, Lafayette, and other towns in Indiana, toward Illinois; were handled on the recently constructed Wabash and Miami canals, emanating in a common trunk from Toledo, one passed southwesterly, and the other struck south to Cincinnati.

"Upon these canals were sumptuous packets, and numerous line boats; and they began to use the convenience and comforts

of a civilized life, and we became very hopeful that we would soon assume city dimensions. But disappointment came over the spirit of our dreams.

"Railroads began to stir the people of the country about these days. From the operations of those already completed, it became evident that they were destined ere long to revolutionize matters pertaining to the business of the towns; materially changing the prestige or destroying by some and building up others.

"On completion of the Mad River Road, passengers who would otherwise have taken the packets at Cincinnati, took the railroad cars on that road and went to Sandusky. And at the west they would leave the canal, and travel 20 and 50 miles out of a direct line to the Michigan Southern to get to Toledo, rather than ride over the canal through our place.

"But a blow came nearer home, the Pittsburgh & Ft. Wayne road was put into operation, and the people of Ft. Wayne, who had been our nearest and most intimate neighbors, became lost to us, and we have seen no more of them to this day. But this was not all, it passed only 30 miles to the south of us, draining and carrying away a country that had been tributary to us.

"But a severer blow than this became impending, first the Junction road, loomed up, its place soon to be taken by the 'Air Line,' with a power behind equal to the occasion, and this was to cut our thither-to tributary

territory within the limits of 15 miles at the north.

"Already the cars were running on this line to Wauseon, and then to Stryker, and our liverymen began running a line of carriages to and fro, to enable our citizens to get to Toledo in that way. Already our leading businessmen began to cast about and talk of moving to Wauseon, Stryker or Bryan. Had we not secured a railroad, and that speedily at this juncture, our doom as a town would have been sealed. We might have retained a rickety school house, a blacksmith shop, and a 'meeting house' for all denominations, but this would have been the extent of our town capacity. 'Tis True, the securing of the Wabash road did not bring to our territory, and so assume to us city proportions, but it put us in a position to become a respectable village, and with our advantages of our canal, made us, as we had hitherto been, the most desirable locality in the northwestern counties away from the lakes for trade and commerce. 'Few really appreciate the really hard efforts and work that was done about the years of 1851-52 by some of the citizens of Defiance to galvanize, as it were, into bringing a railroad that would save the town from impending death.

"As her committee appointed for railroad purposes cast their eyes around, they could see no spark in the horizon, or any place, so big as a man's hand, giving any prospects or hopes, Mr. T.D. Phillips, one of the proprietors of the town, a practical man of business, who had much experience in such matters about Dayton, where he lived, on coming forth from one of the committee meetings, with downcast looks, says, 'Gentlemen, I don't see any chances for you; but the desperate condition the town was in aroused some of the committee, as perhaps,

They had been only once before, and late at night, and early in the morning, they worked, and worked, and worked on. Every railroad and interest, east as far as Buffalo, south as far as Cincinnati, and west as far as Lafayette, was corresponded with and that correspondence would now fill a volume.

"Every railroad meeting within these limits was attended, and in vivid colors in our newspapers was depicted the advantages of routes through Defiance." Suffice it here to say the labors of that 'old committee', resulted in the construction of a railroad from Toledo running southwesterly through Defiance to the state of Illinois.

"The securing of this railroad (WABASH) saved Defiance, and that was all."

While the road saved Defiance, as Mr. Holgate has said, it also had its beneficial results upon Paulding County, opening for its first railroad communication with the great commercial center of the country, east and west. It passes through the townships of Emerald, Crane, Carryall, and Harrison, and has an assessed value in the county of \$266,563, annually, paying into the treasury a tax of over \$6,000.

The second railroad completed in the county was the Paulding & Cecil road, extending between these two points, a distance of seven miles. Its struggles were manifold and its "ups and downs" numerous. The nucleus upon which the road was built was a strap iron track extending two miles south from the Paulding furnace, and used by the company in hauling wood for the kilns. About the year 1877,

George W. Potts, Paulding, purchased M. Doyle the material for a narrow gauge railroad which had been in operation between Columbus and Cincinnati; and rerouted it to Paulding County. With this material proceeded to construct a railroad from Cincinnati point about one-half mile's distance to Paulding.

(To be continued
week)

CIT



Norm's News

'REMEMBER WHEN?'
By NORM RULMAN



This is the type passenger train used on the excursion trip to Toledo in 1950.

Can you remember when the Toledo Union Railroad Station was opened in Sept. of 1950?

The nation's newest and one of its most beautiful railroad terminals, The Toledo Union Station was placed into service this week during a seven-day celebration marking the end of a 40-year wait by the people of northwestern Ohio.

The dingy, old station, built shortly after the assassination of President James A. Garfield, was closed last Sunday and the first ticket was sold in the new \$5,000,000 glass and brick structure.

The big day of The Union Station Dedication Week will be September 28 when special trains will bring throngs from as far east as Sandusky; as far west as Indiana and as far south as Marion.

Residents of northwestern Ohio who join the Saturday Excursion to Toledo will watch a huge parade in celebration of the tearing down the old station, better known as "Toledo's oldest joke."

Visitors will have the opportunity to inspect the latest post-war models of locomotives, sleeping cars, coaches, diners and freight cars brought to

Toledo by the nation's railroads for a unique exhibit in connection with the dedication.

Some of the railroads cooperating were The Wabash - The New York Central - The Baltimore & Ohio - The Chesapeake & Ohio - Nickel Plate Road - The Pennsylvania Railroad - The Ann Arbor Railroad - and The Toledo Terminal Railroad.

Our family had the honor to ride the Wabash that day with many Paulding people, the high school band and others. Passengers were picked up at Cecil, Defiance, Napoleon and all the small towns on into Toledo. The New York Central also picked up passengers at Bryan, Wauseon, and other points into Toledo.

When we arrived in the new Toledo Terminal it was so crowded you could hardly get through the crowds. To get anything to eat, we started uptown Toledo and found a restaurant to get a meal. We later took a trip on the Toledo Terminal Railroad that serves all the business area of Toledo. We departed for home around 6:30 p.m. arriving back at Cecil about 8:50 p.m. It was a long day but the trip was worth it. (Were you on that trip?) and can you (REMEMBER WHEN?)

Today, the only trains that stop to pick up passengers are the two operated by Amtrack called The Lake Shore Limited.

P.S. The Wabash train that we rode on that day in September of 1950 was No. 4-24 and was pulled by a Royal Blue colored Pacific type steam engine. It left Ft. Wayne at 6:35 a.m. traveling through the following towns — New

Haven, - Woodburn - Antwerp - Knoxdale - Cecil - Defiance - Jewell - Okolona - Napoleon - Liberty Center - Colton - Neapolis - Whitehouse - Homewood - Maumee - Toledo Yard and Toledo Station.

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Norm's news

'REMEMBER WHEN?'
By NORM RULMAN

6/22/83



CANALS AND RAIL ROADS IN THE EARLY HISTORY OF PAULDING COUNTY, TAKEN FROM THE HISTORICAL ATLAS.

In May, 1828 Congress made similar grants to Ohio, to aid the construction of the Miami Canal from Dayton to the lake, and also in the same act authorized the State of Indiana to convey to Ohio the right to all possible lands lying within the limits of that state, upon such terms as might be agreed upon by those states. Accordingly, commissioners were chosen from both states — one from each — who met at Zanesville, Ohio in October, 1829, where Indiana, through her commissioners agreed to surrender all the land within the limits of Ohio to the latter named state, on condition that she would construct the canal from the state line to Toledo, and give all the citizens of Indiana all the rights and

privileges that were granted to the citizens of Ohio. Although the Miami canal was the first to be surveyed, yet the Indiana people were the first to do their portion of the work.

"The first ground on the Wabash & Erie was broken at Ft. Wayne in the spring of 1832. The work progressed slowly and by the middle of 1835 only 32 miles had been completed. In 1840 the canal was opened between LaFayette and the east line of Indiana. Ohio was slower than Indiana to appreciate this needed channel of navigation and Indiana, disappointed at this tardiness in 1840 sent their chief engineer to Columbus to urge upon the legislature of Ohio the speedy fulfillment of their portion of the canal contract.

"The Ohio people commenced work immediately, and, in 1843, the final completion of the Wabash & Erie canal took place. The event was celebrated at Fort Wayne on the 4th of July of that year, and was participated in by citizens from both states, who listened to an able oration, delivered upon the occasion, by General Lewis Cass.

"The Miami canal was not completed until 1845, these two canals, of which a brief history has been given, pass through Paulding County, the Wabash & Erie enters the county on the west side and passes through the northern tier of townships; the Miami enters on the south and has a course through the eastern tier of townships. They unite at the Village of Junction. The Indiana portion of the Wabash & Erie canal was entirely abandoned about the year of 1870. This rendering worthless that portion of it between the state line and Junction, was also abandoned by an act of the Ohio State Legislature in 1888, further mention of which will be made later on under the heading of ('The Reservoir War').

"The Miami is yet navigable through the county and is in a tolerable state of repair. That the canals have been of great benefit to the county cannot be gainsaid

or questioned. When in full operation they were the great navigable lines between Toledo and Evansville, a distance of over 500 miles, and between Toledo and Cincinnati, a distance of 242 miles. Upon them was conveyed — as freight, grain, lumber and every other commercial commodity.

"A daily line of packets was established for the conveyance of passengers and the United States mail. These packets were drawn by three horses, driven at a brisk trot and were changed at relays ten miles apart. The schedule time to be made was six miles per hour. Doyke & Dickey were the proprietors of the best line of packets ever established upon these canals, Junction was the pace of transfer for the southern and western branches of the line.

"Once at that place, while the western packet was waiting for the one from the south, its horses were stolen, while the driver was regaling himself in a neighboring restaurant. After some inconvenience and a short delay a new team was purchased and the swift gliding craft proceeded on its way. The proprietor threatened to prosecute the horse thief for obstructing the United States mail, but he was never caught.

"The through line of packets was abandoned in about the year of 1852, as the age of steam had at that time gained a firm footing heading into Paulding County and railroads afforded a much more rapid transit."

(Next week's issue will be the first railroad built through the County.)

KNOW YOUR NEIGHBOR CLUB

Know Your Club met June 1 at Betty St. Johns to leave for the Westgate Dinner Theater. Four members Katherine Dangler, Kate Lucas, Alice Rager, Betty St. John, one inactive member, Joan Shaw and guests Betty Rike, Eileen Vance, Vivian Weidenhamer, Regina Lucas, Velma St. John, Dorothy Wythe, and Evelyn Allensworth made the trip. Showing was "The Unsinkable Molly Brown."

The club is recessed until fall.

NOTES--- COMMENTS

Dollars and sense lay the foundation for fortunes.

If you can express yourself, try not to overdo it.

An individual is not hopeless until he loses his desire for knowledge.

Planning your work is good, but doing it is much better.

Money isn't everything but it's nice to have enough to know that.

Tolerance isn't a matter of conversation; it's the business of living.

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Send a balloon bouquet for any occasion... birthday anniversary... new baby parties... get well free delivery to hospital

"Old Betty," First Train To Come To Paulding



Pictured with the crew is between Section Eight and Paulding, hauling men, supplies, etc. "Old Betty," claimed to be the first engine to come to Paulding. A large stove mill was located at Section Eight about 8 miles West of Paulding. The tramway ran along the road which is now called State Highway 111.

Missouri

OUR RAILROAD IN ANTWERP

Today, the railroad tracks through Antwerp are unusually busy if a train shows up more than a few times a week. It's hard to imagine, looking at the rusty crooked old rails, that those tracks were once part of a vital railroad corridor that stretched from Toledo to Kansas City.

The Wabash Railroad through Antwerp was chartered by a group of businessmen in Toledo, Ohio in 1853. The rail line, initially named The Toledo and Illinois Rail-

road, closely followed the path of the Wabash and Erie Canal, dooming that earlier pathway. It would pass through many small towns on its way to Danville, Illinois. The largest town on the line was Ft. Wayne, Indiana. At the Indiana - Ohio State line, the new railroad would change names, and became The Lake Erie, Wabash, and St. Louis Railroad, although control rested in the same hands as the eastern portion.

Construction began in 1854, and the first train on the new rail line entered New Haven in early 1855. In 1856, the two railroads were for-

mally merged to become The Toledo, Wabash, and Western, which promptly declared bankruptcy and was reorganized as The Toledo and Wabash Railway in October of 1858. In May of 1889 all of the various railroad lines east of St. Louis were finally folded into the umbrella of the Wabash Railroad Company. This company lasted until 1964, when the Norfolk and Western Railroad purchased it. The N&W merged with The Southern Railroad in 1990, and became known as Norfolk Southern. NS still owns the tracks through Antwerp.

Our line through Antwerp weathered many financial storms, including the takeover of the Wabash system by the infamous robber baron Jay Gould. It continued to be a vital part of the Wabash system until 1902, when the Wabash completed a track connecting New Haven and Butler, Indiana. This allowed Wabash trains direct access to Detroit via a Wabash line built in 1880 that operated and continues to operate from Butler through Montpelier, Ohio and Adrian, Michigan to the Delray yards near Detroit. It was no longer necessary to route trains bound for Detroit through Toledo.

Further dooming our line was the 1901 construction of a railroad from Toledo to Montpelier (now abandoned) that allowed direct train operations from Toledo to St. Louis and Kansas City. Our line became a secondary branch line, serving Napoleon, Defiance, and small towns like Liberty Center, Jewell, Okalonā, Cecil, Antwerp, and Woodburn.

In 1989 NS ceased operating the line and leased it

to an independent operator. Under them, the old Wabash line has struggled to maintain any level of operations. Indiana Hi-Rail operated the line from 1989 to 1997. In 1997 Indiana High Rail reorganized, and the Antwerp line became the Maumee and Western.

Maumee and Western is the railroad's current operator.

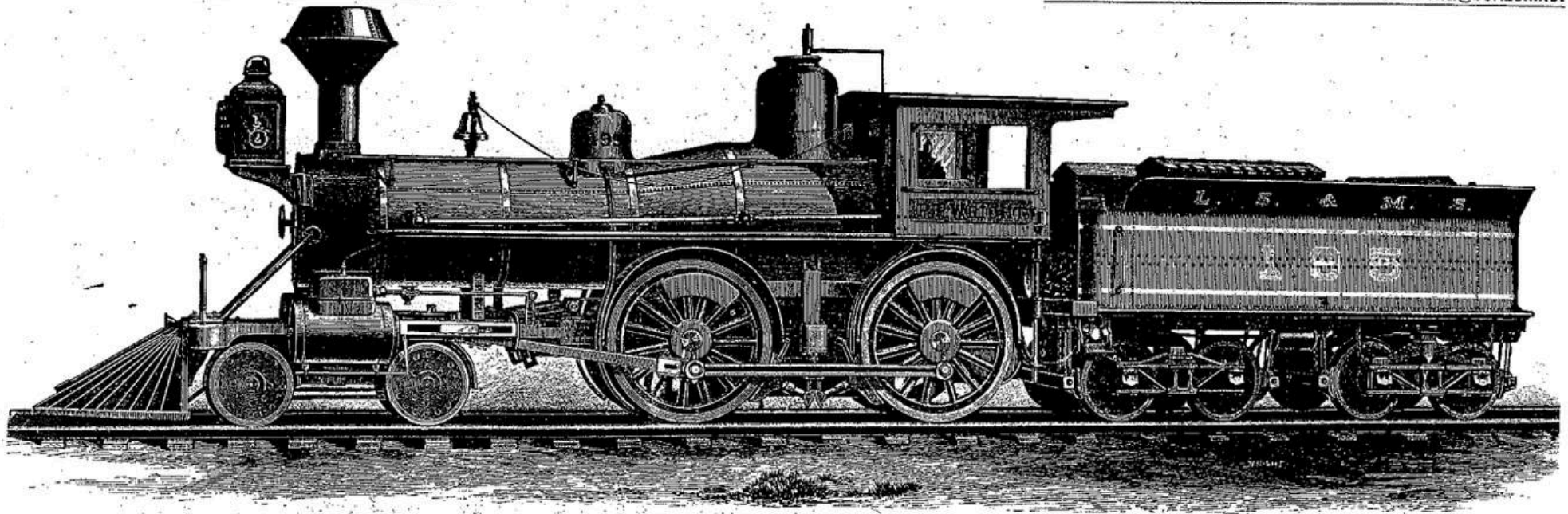
Currently, track from Toledo to Liberty Center has been torn up. The tracks from Liberty Center to Napoleon are out of service because the I&O removed the crossing with its tracks east of Napoleon. Trains still operate between Napoleon and Defiance occasionally. The MAW is unable to cross the CSX tracks in Defiance because that crossing has also been removed. The removal had little practical effect on the railroad, as the section from Defiance to Cecil was closed due to poor track conditions in the 1990's.

The tracks west of Cecil are open to Woodburn, where NS takes over operations into New Haven. The only major shippers on the line through Antwerp are Systech, who supplies fuel to the Hanson Cement plant south of Cecil, and the Antwerp grain elevator.

Next month: The Wabash/Nickel Plate wreck in New Haven, "The Wabash Cannonball", and being "Wabashed".

Note: The engine above more than likely did not travel through Antwerp, but many similar would have.

Keep the news coming. News is always free. Let your friends, neighbors and community know what's going on!



Another Lake Shore flyer was the 195 built in 1886 by Schenectady. It made a fast run with a seven-car train between Buffalo and Chicago in fourteen hours and five minutes (including stops). This

machine and the 220 previously described were designed by George W. Stevens (1847-1907), the road's master mechanic from 1883 to 1899. (*Railroad Gazette*, March 11, 1887, opp. p. 162)

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History of the railroads in Paulding County

The following series of articles have been compiled and submitted by Norman Rulman, local fireman and Post Office employee. We believe the articles will be of special interest since the discontinuance of passenger trains on the Wabash or Toledo-St. Louis R.R. Co. is under consideration.

The first railroad built through Paulding county was the Toledo, Wabash and Western, now called the Wabash, St. Louis and Pacific. Gen. W.H. Gibson and Gen. James B. Steedman had charge of its construction between Defiance and Ft. Wayne. It passes through the northern part for a distance of eighteen miles, and was completed in 1856. The construction of the road, at this comparatively early date, is mainly due to the untiring energy of some of the enterprising citizens of Defiance, as is told by the late Hon. W.C. Holgate of that city, in a historical address before a meeting of the Maumee Valley Pioneer association, and published in the Defiance Democrat, Feb. 28th, 1878.

He says: "Prior to 1842, the chief mode of travel was on foot or on horseback, and the chief means for transporting goods and produce was by flat boats on the river. Our merchants and those of Ft. Wayne obtained their goods in this way from the mouth of the Maumee, where they were brought in lake boats from Buffalo. About this time the Wabash and Toledo, one passed southwesterly through Ft. Wayne, Lafayette, and other towns in Indiana, toward Illinois; and the other struck south to Cincinnati. Upon these canals were sumptuous packets, and numerous line boats; and they began to introduce to us the conveniences and comforts of a civilized life, and we become very hopeful that we would soon assume city dimensions. But disappointment came over the spirit of our dreams. Railroads began to stir the people of the county about these days. From the operations of those already completed, it became evident that they were destined ere long to revolutionize matters pertaining to the business of the towns; materially changing the prestige or destroying some, and building up others.

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prospects or hopes. Mr. T.D. Phillips, one of the proprietors of the town, a practical man of business, who had much experience in such matters about Dayton, where he lived, on coming forth from one of the committee meetings, with downcast looks, says, "Gentlemen, I don't see any chance for you". But the desperate condition the town was now in aroused some on the committee, as perhaps, they had been only once before and late at night & early in the morning, they worked & worked on. Every railroad man and interest east as far as Buffalo, south as far as Cincinnati, and west as far as Lafayette, was corresponded with — and that correspondence would now fill a volume. Every railroad meeting within those limits was attended and in vivid colors in our newspapers was depicted the advantages of routes through Defiance. Suffice it here to say the labors of that "ol committee" resulted in the construction of a railroad from Toledo running southwesterly through Defiance to the state of Illinois. The securing of this Wabash road saved Defiance, and that was all".

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As early as 1838 there was talk of building a railroad from Florida to the Straits of Mackinaw, but there was nothing done upon the project more than to point out the benefits which would arise from such a route. Along in the latter part of the "fifties" a survey was made northward from Cincinnati via Greenville, and a road, called the Mackinaw, was

Paulding. When the interest on the bonds became due, the township trustees, acting under legal advice, refused payment. The olders of the bonds then commenced action to enforce collection, and the case drifted along through various courts. Judge Jackson, of United States Circuit Court, decided in favor of the bond holders. The case was finally settled in Jan., 1891, by a decision of the United States Supreme Court declaring the law unconstitutional under which the bonds were issued. About \$80,000 of these bonds were negotiated, and that amount to gether with the cost of litigation, was lost by those who purchased them in the summer of 1888, the American Midland, or Mahoning railroad was graded through the southern part of the county, paralleled to the Nickel Plate, and about four miles south of it. The road then, like some of its predecessor, passed into a quiet sleep from which it was fully awakened in the fall of 1891. Two trunk lines pass through Paulding county east and west; and the Mackinaw, an excellent road, cleaves her center north and south. Upon the prospects of the Mahoning road the villages of Grover Hill and Mandale were located upon its line in the county. The line was later known as the Findlay Fort Wayne and Western R.R. abandoned in 1920.

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second time were the people interested doomed to disappointment for, as upon the Tiffin and Ft. Wayne, work ceased upon this road never to the resumed, and the magnificent double-tracked "Continental Railway" passes into innocuous desuetude. For nearly ten years it slept as in the sleep of death, but in 1881 it was resurrected by a modest young railroad man of Lima, the Hon. Calvin T. Brice, United States Senator from Ohio.

Mr. Brice, having become largely interested in the Lake Erie an Louisville, and other north and south roads in Ohio, was desirous of obtaining an outlet for his freight to the eastern sea board, and accordingly held an interview with William H. Vanderbilt, to see if said outlet could not be secured over his lines at better rates than those existing. The great railroad king of New York smiled rather derisively upon the young Ohio man and would offer him no inducements. Mr. Brice turned upon his heel and said: "I will build a competing line", and work was begun upon the New York, Chicago and St. Louis railroad. It was completed through the county in September, 1881. While the work was progressing, the old settler looked blankly on and said, "This 'ere road will never be built". Twice had he been deceived by its fickle promises and fake charms and did not propose to be a third time duped. But the third attempt brought the real charm, and the most obstinate doubts was happily disappointed. When he saw the wheels of the iron horse go whirling by he had to believe. The line through the county is a straight one, and has a one minute deflection from a direct east and west course. It traverses the townships of Brown, Jackson, Paulding and Harrison, a distance of twenty-four miles, and has within that distance nine stations. The assessed value of its main track, side tracks, rolling stock, etc. in the county, is placed upon the auditor's duplicate at about \$200,000, so that it pays into the treasurers office a good, round sum as taxes. When Mr. Vanderbilt saw the effect of this competing line upon Lake Shore road, he sought control of it, and it passed into the Vanderbilt system in 1886; Mr. Brice, it is said, clearing a cool \$5,000,000.

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building up others. "One completion of the Mad River road, passengers that would otherwise have taken the packet at Cincinnati and passed through our village to Toledo, took the cars on that road and went to Sandusky. And at the west they would leave the canal, travel twenty and fifty miles out of a direct line north to the Michigan Southern to get to Toledo, rather than ride over the canal through our place. But a blow came nearer home; the Pittsburgh and Ft. Wayne road was put in operation, and the people of Ft. Wayne, who had been our nearest and most intimate neighbors, became lost to us, and we have seen no more of them to this day. But this was not all; it passed only thirty miles to the south of us, draining and carrying away a country that had been tributary to us. But a severer blow than this became impending. First the "Junction Road" loomed up, its place soon to be taken by the "Air Line", with a power behind equal to the occasion, and this was to cut our hitherto tributary territory within the limits of fifteen miles at the north. Already the cars were running on this to Wauseon, and then to Stryker, and our lively men began running a line of carriages to and fro, to enable our citizens to get to Toledo in this way. Already our leading businessmen began to cast about and talk of removing to Wauseon, Stryker or Bryan. Had we not secured a railroad and that speedily at this junction, our doom as a town would have been sealed. We might have retained a rickety school house, a black smith shop, and a "meeting house" for all denominations, but this would have been the extent of our town capacity. "Tis true", the securing of the Wabash road did not bring back to us our tributary territory, and so assure to us city proportions; but it put us in a position to become a respectable village, and with the advantages of our canal, made us, as we had hitherto been, the most desirable locality in these north western counties away from the lakes for trade and commerce.

"Few appreciate the really hard efforts and work that was done about the years of 1851-2 by some of the citizens of Defiance to galvanize, as it were, into being a railroad that would save the town from impending death. As her committee appointed for railroad purposes cast their eyes around, they could see no spark in the horizon, or any place, so big as a man's hand, giving any

made northward from Cincinnati via Greenville, and a road, called the Mackinaw, was partly graded as far north as Van Wert. Work suddenly ceased upon this road, and for more than twenty years nothing was heard of the Mackinaw. In 1880 the citizens of Van Wert, organized the Cincinnati, Van Wert and Michigan railway company, with Joan M.C. Marble as president, and began work on a road extending both north and south from that place. The first portion of the road completed was from Van Wert to Shane's crossing eight miles south. From this point it slowly but steadily advanced from town to town until it reached Franklin. On the Cincinnati Hamilton and Dayton railroad, whence it seems its trains over that road to Cincinnati, this was accomplished in 1887, seven years after the road was begun. The slowness of its construction was from the following cause: The company depended upon local aid to erect the first portion of the road, and then upon the earning of the portions completed to build the remainder. The road was completed to Paulding in 1884, and by purchasing the Paulding and Cecil road secured an outlet to the Wabash at Cecil. From this point trains were run south until 1887, when the road was pushed on northward into the state of Mich. The company was reorganized about this time and the name of the road changed to the Cincinnati Jackson and Mackinaw.

The road is very convenient for the citizens of Paulding county, as they can leave Paulding on the early morning trains, arrive at Cincinnati about 10:00 a.m., have five or six hours in that city, and reach home the same day. It passed through the townships of Blue Creek, Paulding and Crane, a distance of eighteen miles in the county, and is assessed at about \$3,000 per mile. Its stations in the county are Scott, Former, Dague, Latty, Paulding, Holcombe, Furnace and Cecil. It crosses the Nickel Plate at Latty, and the Wabash at Cecil. In the winter of 1882, the Ohio Legislature passed an act authorizing certain townships along the line of the road to vote a bonded indebtedness for aid in its construction. Among the townships which voted in favor of issuing bonds were Pleasant and Union, in Van Wert county; Dublin, in Mercer county; Blue Creek, in Paulding county. The bonds were sold and the money applied in building the line to

narrow gauge railroad, which had been in operation between Columbus and North Columbus; and, removed it to Paulding county. With this material he proceeded to construct a railroad from Cecil to a point about one-half mile distance from Paulding.

It was a rickety affair, & it is thought that the proprietor never realized much profit upon the amount he invested in building it. In 1879, John F. R. Evans, with the aid of citizens of Paulding and Cecil, began the construction of a standard guage road between these points, which, being completed the first train ran over it into Paulding, September 1st, 1880. In 1881 it passed into the hands of the Paulding and Cecil railway company, with S. Frank Eagle as president, and was operated by that company until 1884, when it was sold to the Cincinnati, Van Wert and Michigan railway company, and became a part of what is now the Cincinnati, Jackson and Mackinaw road.

THE NICKEL PLATE R. R.

A history of the New York, Chicago and St. Louis railroad, or "Nickel Plate", as it is familiarly known, may be briefly told: In May, 1854, the citizens of Paulding county were startled by the sudden appearances of a corp of engineers engaged in running a railroad line from Tiffin to Ft. Wayne. Shortly after the line was located, contractors began work and the mud was cut out and partly graded through the country. In the autumn of the same year, work was suspended for the winter, with the assurance that it would be resumed the following spring. Spring came, but with it came no orders to begin work on the Tiffin and Ft. Wayne railroad, and they never came. The financial embarrassment of the leaders of the enterprise, had caused a permanent suspension, and many contractors and employees under them suffered a loss of being unpaid for their labor. In 1872 a new company was formed, a resurvey of the line was made and work begun. This time it was called the "Continental Railway," and was to be the great double tracked thoroughfare between New York City and Omaha. So confident were all that the road would this time be built that villages were located at every available point along the line, store rooms and ware houses were erected, and corner lots arose to fabulous prices. But a

it passed into the Vanderbilt system in 1886; Mr. Brice, it is said clearing a cool \$5,000,000 by the deal. So much for the pluck



WE HAVE THE PLAN
\$20,000 BY THE FD
It has been
serve our fr
past 77 year



ANTWERP

and energy of an Ohio man, who, if he did not belong directly to Paulding county, was born in the adjoining county of Putnam.

A reminiscence of Paulding County, Ohio around the turn of the century

PAULDING COUNTY,



SESQUICENTENNIAL 1820-1970

A reminiscence of Paulding County, Ohio around the turn of the century.

On a recent stopover in the town where I spent my early boyhood, I learned that this year of 1970 is the sesquicentennial of the founding of Paulding Co., named for John Paulding, one of three Revolutionary War patriots who captured the British officer, Major Andre who conspired with General Benedict

Arnold (a name that has become synonymous with treason) to surrender West Point on the Hudson to the Redcoats, for a price. If the plan had succeeded, the history of this nation of ours might well have been much different, in the light of what happened to some of Britain's other colonial possessions. I learned of this decisive episode early in life and have always been proud of the fact that I

hailed from a part of the country so named.

I was not born in Paulding, but not too far east in Putnam Co., (named for another patriot) in a place called Hector on the Nickel Plate R.R. a short distance east of Continental. I might add here that I had an awful narrow escape; my parents considered naming me for the town. It was a

(Continued on next page)

SAINT FRANCIS COLLEGE

FALL SEMESTER CO-EDUCATIONAL

Sept. 15, 1970 -- Jan. 26, 1971

GRADUATE OFFERINGS

Registration Procedure—Approval Times to Register and Registration, Monday, Aug. 31, through Friday, Sept. 4, 8:30 a.m. to 12 noon, 1-4:30 p.m.; Tuesday, Sept. 8, through Friday, Sept. 11, 8:30 a.m. to 12 noon, 1-4:30 p.m.; Saturday, Sept. 12, 8-11:30 a.m., 1:30-3 p.m. Please secure approval to register from Graduate Office—No approval to register before Aug. 31—Pay tuition and fees at Business Office. Complete registration in Registrar's Office, have social security number with you.

Co-educational—Courses leading to Master of Arts and Master of Science in Education, with majors in Guidance and Counseling; Reading Specialization; School Psychometry; Special Education, Mental Retardation; Social Service Work; and general subject matter teaching fields. Also, Master of Science in Business Administration.

Dept.	No.	Course	Sem.	Hrs.	Time	Days
Art	501	Arts Crafts for Elem Tchrs	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Art	502	Design for Elem Teachers	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	M	
Art	510	Painting	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	W	
Art	521	Graphics Wood cuts Engrng	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	W	
Art	536	Metalcraft (Jewelry)	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	M	
Art	545	Weaving	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Biol	456	Problems in School Health	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	Th	
Biol	500	Gen Science for Elem Tchrs	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Biol	510	Prin of Biol for Sec Tchrs	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	M	
Bus	500	Economics	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	T	
Bus	515	Managerial Accounting	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	W	
Bus	530	Principles of Management	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	M	
Bus	580	Marketing Policies	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	F	
Bus	557	Commercial Bank Mngmnt	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	Th	
E Sc	510	Astronomy for Teachers	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	T	
Educ	500A	Methodology Educ Research	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Educ	500B	Methodology Educ Research	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	M	
Educ	500C	Methodology Educ Research	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	Th	
Educ	500D	Methodology Educ Research	3	8:30 a.m.-11:50 a.m.	S	
Educ	502A	Methodology Educ Research	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	W	
Educ	500E	Elem School Curriculum	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	Th	
Educ	502B	Elem School Curriculum	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	W	
Educ	510	Tests and Measurements	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	W	
Educ	512A	High School Curriculum	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	T	
Educ	512B	High School Curriculum	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	M	
Educ	525	Non-Graded (a 2-semester course)	3	4:00 p.m.-5:30 p.m.	W	
Educ	540	Educ Vac Guid Inform Serv	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	M	
Educ	542	Guidance for Elem Teachers	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	M	
Educ	543	Prin Organ Adm of Guid	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Eng	540	American Literature	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Fm A	503	Nutrition Education	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	Th	
Fren	500	Linguistics	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Hist	501	19th Century Europe	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	W	
Hist	506	American Revolution	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Math	500	Intro Math Elem Tchrs	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	W	
Math	501	Mod Concepts Math Elem Tchrs	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	W	
Math	516	Probability and Statistics	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	M	
Math	540	Topology	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	M	
Mus	505	Adv Chorus Choral Technq	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	M	
Mus	514	Music Theory	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	Th	
Mus	522	Sem Instrm Technq Brass	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
P Ed	593	Curr in Health, Phys Educ	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	M	
Psy	503	Psy of Perception Learning	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Psy	508	Statistics in Educ and Psy	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	M	
Psy	521	Advanced Educational Psy	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	W	
Psy	524	Psychology of Personality	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Psy	534	Adv Hum Growth Develop	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	Th	
Psy	535	Abnormal Psychology	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	T	
Psy	536	Psy Exceptional Children	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	Th	
Psy	550	Psychological Testing	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	M	
Psy	551	Individual Mental Tsting I	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	W	
Psy	552	Clinical Counseling Psy	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	Th	
Psy	553	Projectives I	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	T	
Psy	555	Techniques of Counseling	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	M	
Psy	556	Practicum in Counseling	3	8:30 a.m.-11:50 a.m.	S	
Psy	557	Fid Experiences in Consng	3	8:30 a.m.-11:50 a.m.	S	
Psy	558	Psychotherapy I	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	Th	
Psy	565	Internship Sch Psychometry	3	8:30 a.m.-3:30 p.m.	M-F	
Psy	575	Theories Practices Consng	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	Th	
Read	560	Psychology of Reading	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	Th	
Read	561	Diag Corr Procedures Rding	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Read	562	Develop Reading	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	M	
Read	565	Practicum in Reading-Elem	3	8:30 a.m.-12:20 p.m.	S	
Read	570	Supervision in Tchng Read	3	8:30 a.m.-12:20 p.m.	S	
Read	580	Clinical Diag of Reading	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	Th	
Soc	550	Sem Soc Issues Frces Change	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	Th	
Span	570	The Generation of 1898	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	W	
Sp Ed	510	Spec Mlds El for Ment Retr	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	T	
Sp Ed	501	Supervised Tchng-Ment Retr	3	4:30 p.m.-7:15 p.m.	W	
Sp Ed	510P	Prac Super Tchng-Ment Retr	3	8:30 a.m.-12:00 noon	S	
Sp Ed	521	Organ Comm Serr for Handi	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	W	
Sp Ed	526	Survey Spch Sci Correction	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	Th	
Sp Ed	520	Physio-Psy Found Ment Retr	3	7:35 p.m.-10:20 p.m.	T	

The college reserves the right to discontinue any class because of insufficient enrollment. Late registration, after Sept. 12, \$10.

2791 Spring St.

Fort Wayne 46808

Tel. 432-3551

8-10-83

Norm's news

'REMEMBER WHEN?'

 PAULDING COUNTY LIBRARY
 205 SOUTH MAIN
 PAULDING, OHIO 45879


SOME MORE HISTORY OF PAULDING COUNTY ON OUR RAILROADS.

As early as 1838 there was talk of building a railroad from Florida to the straits of Mackinac, but there was nothing done on the project more than to point out the benefits which would arise from such a route.

Along in the latter part of the 50s, a survey was made northward from Cincinnati via Greenville, and a road called the Mackinac, was partly graded as far north as Van Wert. Work suddenly ceased upon this road, and for more than 20 years nothing was heard of the Mackinac. In 1880 the citizens of Van Wert, realizing the importance of a north and south road to their town, organized the Cincinnati, Van Wert & Mackinac railway company, with John M. C. Marble as president, and began work on a road extending both north and south from that place. The first portion of the road completed was between Van Wert to Shane's

Crossing, eight miles north.

From this point it slowly but steadily advanced from town to town, until it reached Franklin, on the Cincinnati, Hamilton & Dayton railroad, whence it runs the trains over that road to Cincinnati.

This was accomplished in 1887, seven years after the road was begun.

The slowness of the construction was from the following cause: the company depended upon local aid to erect the first portion of the road, and then upon the earnings of the portion completed to build the remainder.

The road was completed to Paulding in 1884, and by purchasing the Paulding & Cecil road secured an outlet to the Wabash at Cecil.

From this point trains were run south until about 1887, when the road was pushed on northward into the State of Michigan.

The company was reorganized about this time and the name of the road changed to Cincinnati, Jackson and Mackinac. The road was

very convenient for the citizens of Paulding County, as they could leave Paulding on the early morning train, arrive at Cincinnati about 10 a.m., have five or six hours in that city, and reach home the same day.

This railroad passes through the townships of Blue Creek, Paulding and Crane, a distance of 18 miles in the county, and is assessed at about \$3,000 per mile. Stations in the county are Scott, Folmer, Dague, Latty, Paulding, Holcombe, Furnace and Cecil.

It crosses the Nickel Plate at Latty, and the Wabash at Cecil.

In the winter of 1882, the Ohio Legislature passed an act authorizing certain townships along the line of the road to vote a bonded indebtedness for aid in the construction. Among the townships which voted in favor of issuing bonds were Pleasant and Union in Van Wert county; Duolin in Mercer county; and Blue Creek in Paulding county. The bonds were sold and the money applied in building the line to Paulding. When the interest on these bonds became due, the townships trustees acting under legal advice, refused payment. The holders of these bonds then commenced action to enforce collection, and the case drifted along through various courts.

Judge Jackson of the United States circuit court decided in favor of the bond holders. The

case was finally settled in January, 1891, by a decision of the United States supreme court declaring the law unconstitutional under which the bonds were issued.

About \$80,000 of these bonds were negotiated, and that amount, together with the cost of litigation, was lost by those who purchased them.

In the summer of 1888, the American Midland, or Mahoning Railroad, was graded through the southern part of the county, parallel to the Nickel Plate, and about four miles south of it.

The road was then, like some of its predecessors, passed into a quiet sleep from which it was fully awakened in the fall of 1891. Two trunk lines pass through Paulding County east and west, and the Mackinac, an excellent road, cleaves her center north and south. Upon the completion of the Mahoning road the villages of Grover Hill and Mandale were located upon its line in the county.

ICE CREAM SOCIAL

An ice cream social will be held from 4:30 to 7 p.m. August 20 at the Paulding United Methodist Church basement. SOUTH MAIN Menu will consist of home made ice cream, pie, cake, hot beef sandwiches, hot dogs, cole slaw, baked beans and hot and cold drinks.

Proceeds will go to the church building fund.

Mar 10, 1943

V.F. Railroads #11

V.F.



Norm's news

"REMEMBER WHEN"
By NORM RULMAN

RAILROADS IN THE WAR AND WHAT PROPORTION OF UNITED STATES TROOPS AND MILITARY SUPPLIES WERE MOVED BY RAIL IN WORLD WAR II:

More than 97 percent of all troops and more than 90 percent of all Army equipment and supplies and about 90 percent of all Navy equipment and supplies were transported by rail during the war.

From December 1941 to August 1945 inclusive, a total of 113,891 special troop trains were operated for distances ranging all the way up to 3,000 miles or more.

In addition, the railroads handled an even greater number of special troop cars in regular scheduled trains. The special train movements

involved 303,003 coach trips, 511,385 sleeping car trips, 142,706 baggage and kitchen car trips and 193,784 refrigerator, box, flat, and gondola car trips, besides an almost equal movement of empty cars to and from loading and unloading points.

From December 1, 1941 to the end of August 1945, the railroads transported 43,700,000 members of the United States Army, Navy, Marines and Coast Guard in special troop or hospital trains, or in special cars attached to regular trains.

The average monthly movement during this forty-five month period was 971,110 troops.

This was more than twice the average monthly movement during World War I.

The foregoing figures

do not include many millions of railway trips made by unarmored men traveling singly or in small groups in line of duty or on furlough, nor do they include those returning to their homes after being discharged from the service.

To move an infantry division of about 15,000 men and their equipment requires 63 trains with a total of 1,350 cars.

To move the men and the 3,000 vehicles in an armored division requires about 75 trains of from 28 to 45 cars each, depending on the length of the cars and the size and equipment of the various units which travel each train.

A total of 351,451 employees of the railroads, the Pullman Company and the Railway Express Agency entered military service up to the end of World War II—enough to form 23 army divisions of 15,000 men each.

Military railway battalions of the Army Transportation Corps, of which 856 percent were American railroad men, operated railroads during the war in England, French Morocco, Algeria, Tunisia, Sicily, Italy, France, Holland, Belgium, Luxembourg,

Germany, Austria, Iran, India, Burma, New Guinea, New Caledonia, the Philippines, and the Yukon District of Canada.

They also operated railroads in Alaska. Following the war they operated railroads in Japan and Korea. The total Military Railway Service personnel on June 30, 1945, included 43,306 officers and enlisted men.

With one-fourth fewer employees, one-third fewer locomotives, one-fourth fewer freight cars and one-third fewer passenger cars than they had in World War I, the railroads of the United States, each month on the average moved about twice as many troops, performed more than twice as many passenger-miles of service, moved more than five times as much Army freight and express, twenty times as much Navy freight for overseas destinations and nearly double as many ton-miles of freight of all kinds as they moved in World War I—and they performed this unprecedented task without the prolonged delays and the congestion of the first World War.

EVERY WEEK FOR THE NEXT 3 WEEKS...

IT'S RCA WEEK

AMAZING
UNIQUE